

RUH Airport Status

HALTED

As of 4:55 PM, Saturday 10 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

257 flights cancelled today · last takeoff 1:39 PM · last landing 2:05 PM

Airport halted since 2:05 PM, 175 minutes with no takeoff or landing. Last takeoff XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing SM461 at 2:05 PM. Morning halt 6:37–8:08 AM still unexplained. Cancellations remain elevated.

HEADLINE

Airport halted since 2:05 PM (175 minutes, no takeoff or landing); {total} flights cancelled today so far.

There were 0 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh at 1:39 PM. The latest landing was SM461 from Cairo at 2:05 PM, with 0 landings in the last hour. 257 flights are cancelled today (134 departures, 123 arrivals) and 19 arrivals have diverted. **Yesterday, 9 October:** 166 of 703 flights cancelled, 18 arrivals diverted and four halts of 45+ minutes, the longest 7:41 to 9:38 PM (no landing until 9:45 PM). No official reason has been given for the evening stop. **This morning:** a 91-minute halt ran from 6:37 to 8:08 AM with no takeoff or landing. **This afternoon:** the board shows another stop since 2:05 PM — about 175 minutes with no takeoff or landing as of this check (last takeoff flynas XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing Air Cairo SM461 at 2:05 PM). No official explanation. Air Arabia has suspended Sharjah–Riyadh through Sunday; SriLankan Airlines remains suspended to Riyadh until 18 October; Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia are still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday. Reuters reports major Saudi conferences are still planned to go ahead despite Thursday's airport attack. Board cancellations remain elevated.

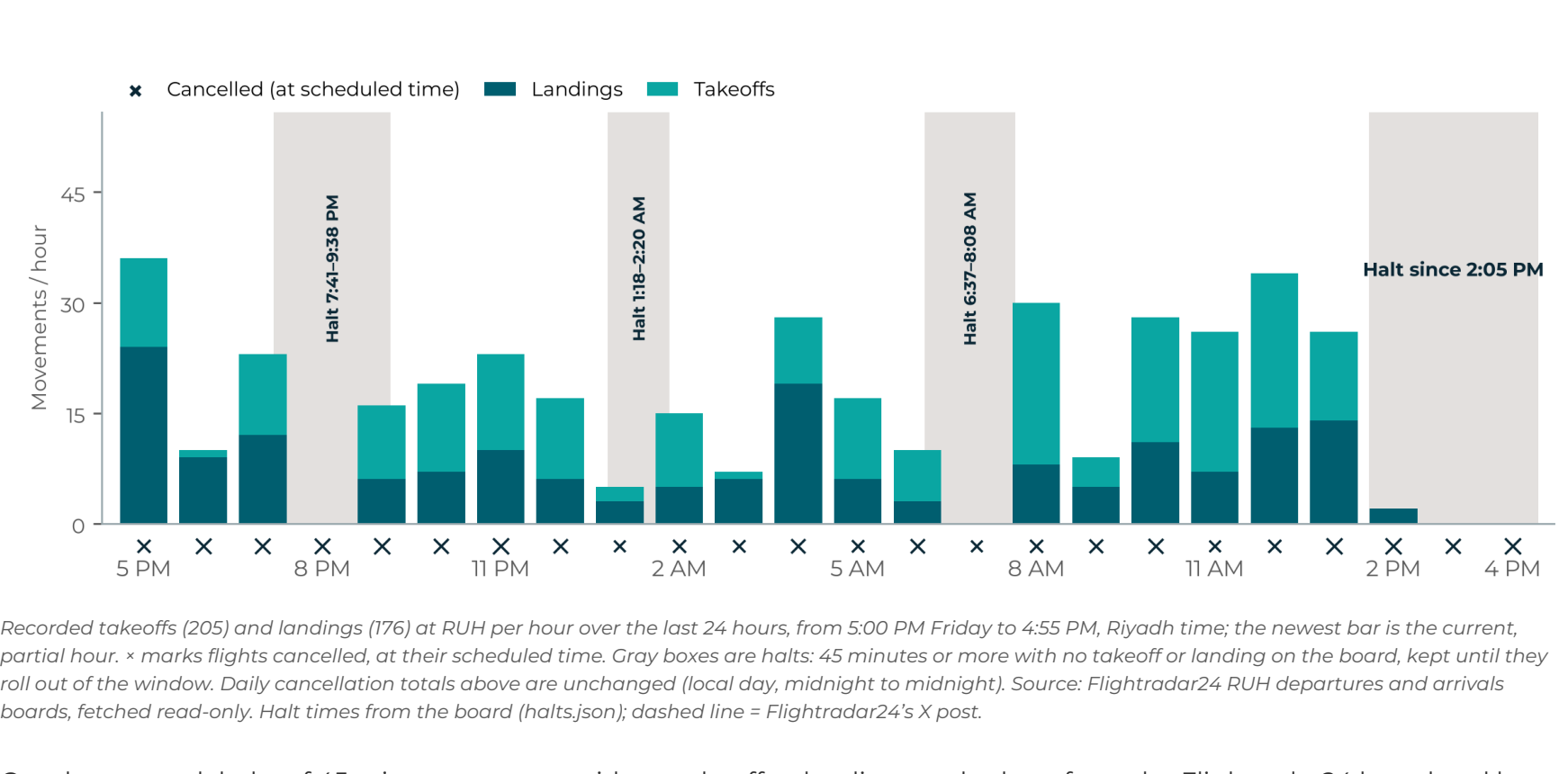
257	1:39 PM	2:05 PM	0	19
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
134 departures + 123 arrivals, 33% of 769 scheduled.	XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh, 196 min before 4:55 PM.	SM461 from Cairo, 170 min before 4:55 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Madinah, Dammam, Qassim.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshores and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 4:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 256 (133 departures, 34%, 123 arrivals, 32%) at 4:56 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS				
MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today	133 (34%)	123 (32%)	256	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled today, board count	134	123	257	FR24 boards, local day
Delayed today	128 (33%)	101 (27%)	229	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	45 (26%)	29 (22%)	74	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	70 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Disruption index (0–5)	2.34	5	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	146 of 274	108 of 238	254 of 512	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	19	19	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	37	63	100	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	75	96	171	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5		MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5	
Saudia	157	Jeddah	51
flyadeal	17	Dubai	22
Riyadh Air	8	Istanbul	15
Qatar Airways	8	Dammam	15
Turkish Airlines	7	Madinah	12

Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport,json details/stats panel, fetched 4:56 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 4:55 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently; so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

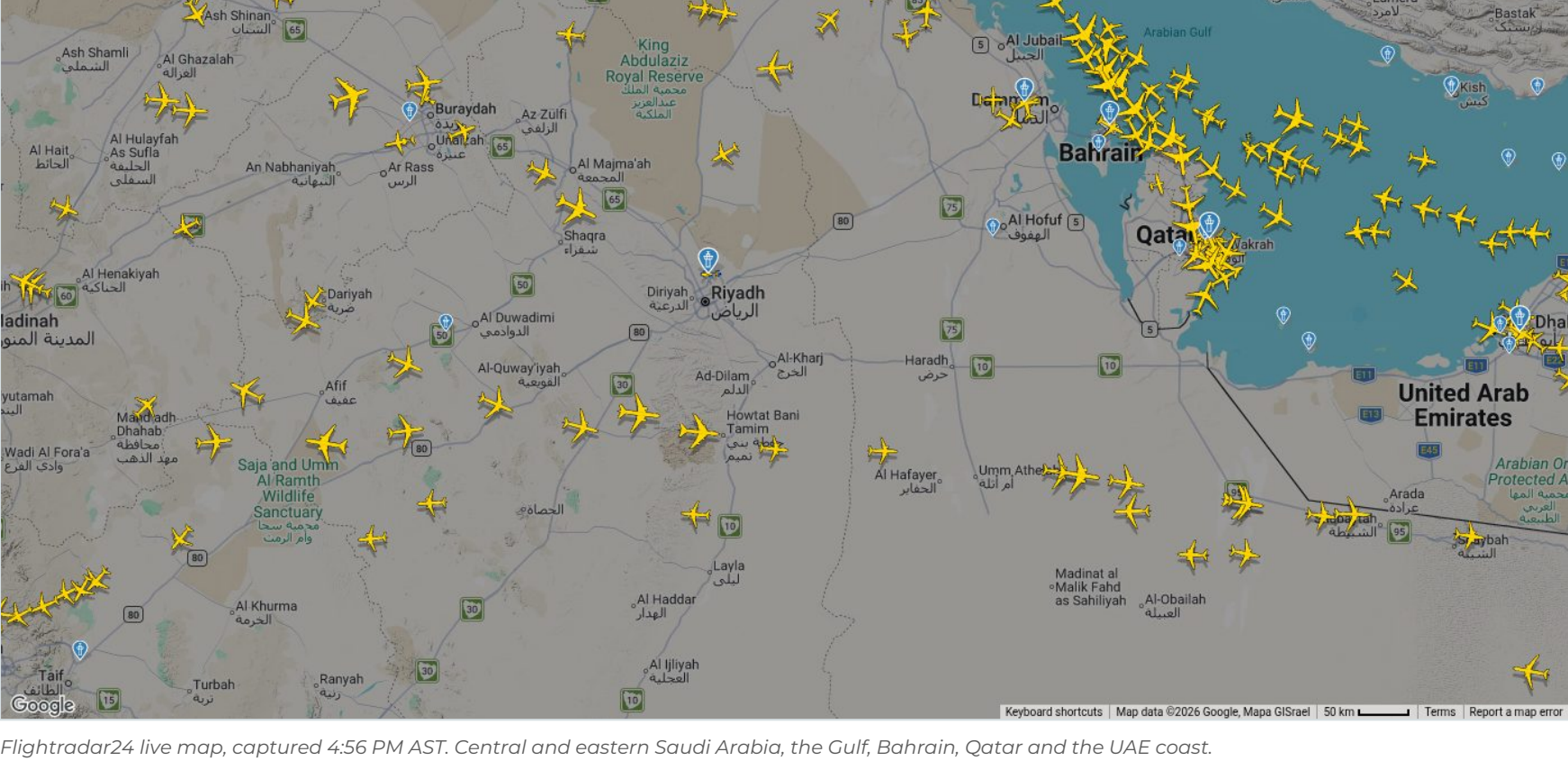
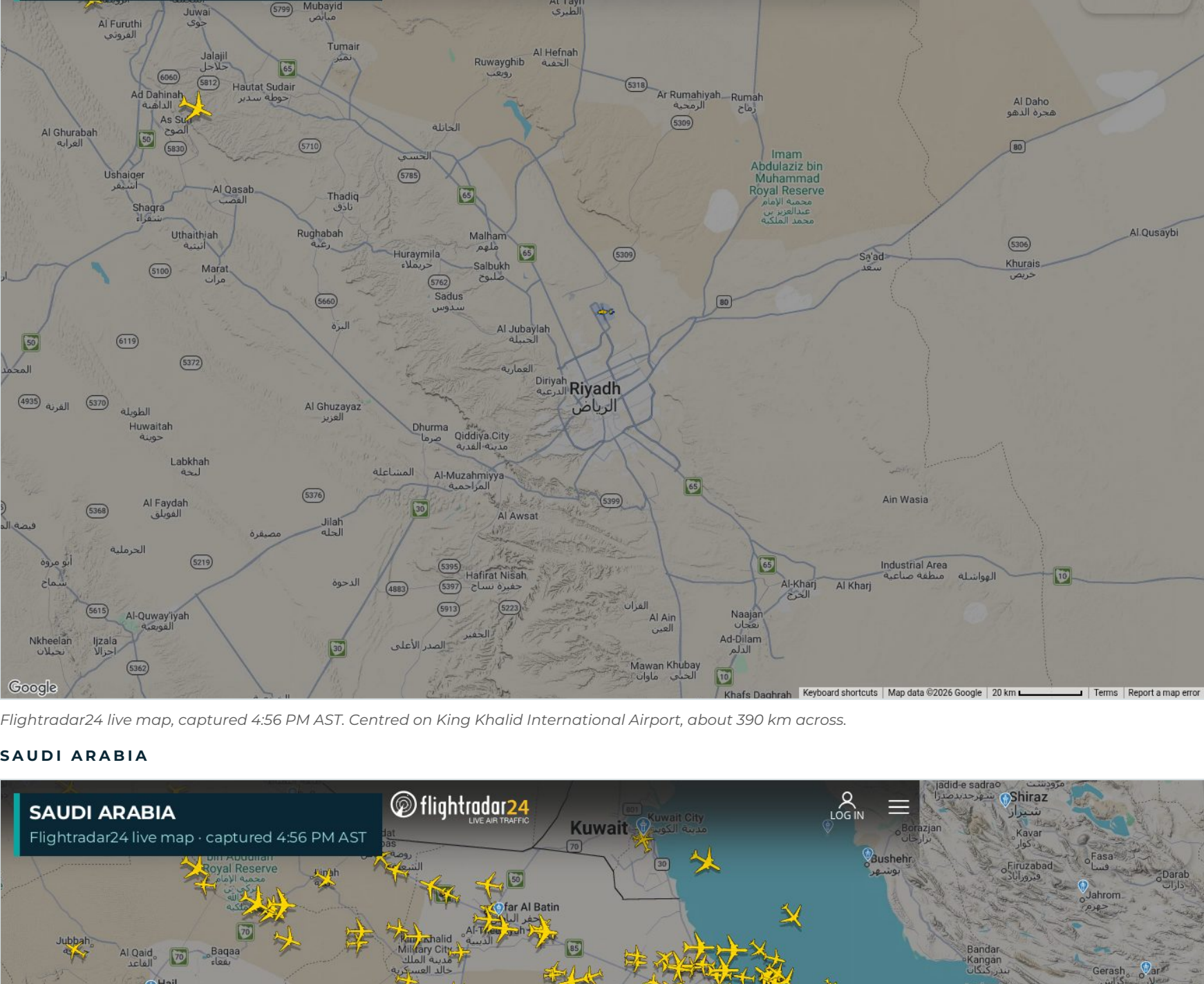


Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): yesterday 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, 7:41–9:38 PM, overnight 1:18–2:20 AM, this morning 6:37–8:08 AM, and the open afternoon halt since 2:05 PM.

AIRSPACE NOW

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Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.



Read with care: the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

WATCHED GULF ROUTES

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Next departures from RUH: 2 of 5 routes on schedule.

ROUTE	FLIGHT	AIRLINE	SCHEDULED	ESTIMATE	STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT	CANCELLED
Dubai (DXB)	XY207	flynas	3:50 PM	3:50 PM	Has not left yet	11
Bahrain (BAH)	XY233	flynas	6:00 PM	6:00 PM	On schedule	1
Muscat (MCT)	WY682	Oman Air	9:50 PM	9:50 PM	On schedule	3
Abu Dhabi (AUH)	EY556	Etihad Airways	4:45 PM	5:00 PM	Delayed	1
Doha (DOH)	QR8731	Qatar Airways	11:45 AM	—	Has not left yet	5

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 4:55 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight itself on schedule = no later estimate; delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR1241, QR1169, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Etihad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; SalamAir OV206 to Muscat.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

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Airport halted since 2:05 PM (~175 min, no takeoff or landing); Reuters: major Saudi conferences still going ahead; Air Arabia suspends Sharjah–Riyadh through Sunday; SriLankan still suspended to 18 Oct; UAE carriers still cutting Saturday; GACA silent on today's stops.

Checked at 4:55 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED Reuters: major Saudi conferences to proceed despite deadly airport attack

Reuters · 2:40 PM · published ~2:40 PM AST (Reuters 10 Oct ~11:40 UTC); last checked 4:55 PM

Reuters reports organisers say major Saudi conferences are still planned to go ahead despite Thursday's deadly attack on King Khalid airport that killed three people and damaged a Saudia aircraft. The report notes security concerns around the Future Investment Initiative and other gatherings; it does not give new RUH operational figures. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED Air Arabia suspends Sharjah–Riyadh, Tabuk and Abha flights through Sunday

Aviation Voice / The Morning / Newswire · 1:45 PM · published / last updated ~1:45 PM AST (Gulf Today 10 Oct); last checked 4:55 PM

Gulf Today reports Air Arabia has temporarily suspended Sharjah–Riyadh flights G9151 and G9154 on Saturday and Sunday (10–11 October), plus Tabuk G9634 on 11 October and Abu Dhabi–Abha G9195 on both days, with services expected to resume Monday 12 October pending further changes. The same report notes Emirates, Etihad and flydubai suspensions through 11 October. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED SriLankan Airlines suspends all Riyadh flights until 18 October

Aviation Voice / The Morning / Newswire · 12:20 PM · published ~12:20–12:45 PM AST (Aviation Voice / The Morning / Newswire 10 Oct); last checked 4:55 PM

Aviation Voice, The Morning and Newswire report SriLankan Airlines has temporarily suspended all flights to Riyadh until 18 October 2026 after the security incident at King Khalid airport, citing ongoing safety and operational assessments. The airline said services will resume once conditions are considered suitable. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED UAE Vartha: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancel UAE–Riyadh services Saturday

UAE Vartha · 11:00 AM · published 10 Oct 2026 (UAE Vartha); last checked 4:55 PM

UAE Vartha reports Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia cancelled multiple UAE–Riyadh services on Saturday, citing operational disruption at King Khalid airport, with spillover cancellations to Abha and Yanbu. Etihad grounded EY551/EY555 and EY552/EY556 while keeping EY559/EY560; Emirates cancelled EK815/EK819 and EK816/EK818/EK820; flydubai scrubbed FZ847/FZ841/FZ855 and FZ848/FZ842/FZ856; Air Arabia cancelled Sharjah–Riyadh and Abha rotations. Board totals in this edition are the live Flightradar24 figures.

CONFIRMED Gulf News: Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday

Gulf News · 9:21 AM · published 9:21 AM AST (Gulf News 10:21 AM GST); last checked 4:55 PM

Gulf News reports travellers between the UAE and Riyadh still face cancellations on Saturday from Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia. flydubai lists Riyadh and Yanbu cancellations through 10 October and Abha through 11 October; Etihad cites operational cancellation at Riyadh airport. Flightradar24 board figures in this edition are the live totals.

CONFIRMED Anadolu / Alekhbariya: passenger flow at Anadolu described as smooth after Thursday attacks

Anadolu Agency / News.az · 10:10 AM · published ~10:10 AM (News.az / Anadolu dated 10 Oct); last checked 4:55 PM

Anadolu Agency, citing Saudi state TV Alekhbariya, says passenger movement at King Khalid is flowing smoothly and air traffic returned to normal on Friday after the Thursday attacks that killed three Saudi citizens. GACA had said operations resumed Friday. This edition's board still shows elevated Saturday cancellations and airline suspensions; no official comment on this morning's 6:37–8:08 AM halt.

CONFIRMED PIA suspends Riyadh flights; Lufthansa, Etihad and flydubai cuts continue

Dawn · 4:43 AM · published 4:43 AM (Dawn updated); last checked 4:55 PM

Dawn reports Pakistan International Airlines temporarily suspended flights to Riyadh, citing the Middle East situation. The same roundup notes Lufthansa Group suspended Riyadh services until 16 October, Etihad cancelled further Abu Dhabi–Riyadh flights into Saturday, and flydubai cancelled Riyadh and Yanbu through 10 October. Flightradar24 figures cited there are earlier; see this edition's board totals for today.

UNVERIFIED Social posts claim a Ugandan national was killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport

Unverified accounts on X · 7:45 AM · published ~7:45 AM; last checked 4:55 PM

Accounts on X name Ugandan bus driver Muwenda Edward as killed in a Houthi missile attack at Riyadh airport. GACA's confirmed fatality count remains three Saudi citizens from the 8 October attacks; no official confirmation of this additional name as of this check.

METHOD AND LIMITS

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What the numbers are, and are not.

- Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf routes, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards fetched at 4:55 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airports feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
4:55 PM, Sat 10 Oct	4:55 PM	Flightradar24, Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Dawn, Gulf News	Halted	Open sources · not official	6:00 PM